HOORVIA - BAKING INGREDIENT SUBSTITUTIONS CHEAT SHEET

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · US Letter Printable

Kitchen & Cooking

Need 1 unit of...	Use instead	Expect
1 cup butter	1 cup coconut oil (solid) or ¾ cup + 2 tbsp vegetable oil	Slightly less rich; oil cakes stay moist longer
1 cup butter (dairy-free)	1 cup dairy-free margarine or solid coconut oil	Check salt - margarine is often salted
1 large egg	3 tbsp aquafaba, or 1 tbsp ground flax + 3 tbsp water (rest 5 min)	Good for muffins/cakes; less lift in sponge cakes
1 cup buttermilk	1 cup milk + 1 tbsp lemon juice or vinegar (rest 5 min)	Near-identical in most recipes
1 cup whole milk	1 cup oat/soy milk, or ½ cup evaporated milk + ½ cup water	Plant milks vary in sweetness
1 cup all-purpose flour	1 cup + 2 tbsp cake flour (lighter) - or spoon-and-level carefully	Do not pack flour into the cup
1 cup self-raising flour	1 cup plain flour + 1½ tsp baking powder + ¼ tsp salt	Mix well before using
1 cup granulated sugar	1 cup caster sugar, or ¾ cup honey (reduce liquid by 2-3 tbsp)	Honey browns faster - lower oven by 25°F / 15°C
1 cup brown sugar	1 cup white sugar + 1 tbsp molasses	Close in flavour and moisture
1 tsp baking powder	¼ tsp baking soda + ½ tsp cream of tartar	Use immediately - it activates fast
1 tsp baking soda	3 tsp baking powder (only if recipe has no acid - texture may differ)	Not a perfect swap; use only in a pinch
1 cup sour cream	1 cup plain Greek yogurt	Very close; yogurt is a little tangier
1 cup heavy cream (baking)	¾ cup milk + ? cup melted butter (not for whipping)	Works in batters/sauces, will not whip
1 oz unsweetened chocolate	3 tbsp cocoa powder + 1 tbsp oil or butter	Good for brownies and cakes

PRO TIP: Print on US Letter or A4 - the print dialog's "Save as PDF" option gives you a clean PDF in either size - and keep the sheet inside a baking cupboard or taped to the inside of a pantry door, where you will see it before you start measuring. Laminate it if your baking area gets floury, because a paper sheet near butter and eggs rarely stays clean for long. Many bakers also keep a second copy in a recipe binder, so the swaps are there when a recipe calls for buttermilk at the last minute and the shops are closed.